Theme 4 title 3 Child Edition

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THE BIG BEGINNING
How the First Stories of the Bible Point to Jesus
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A Note for Parents

Have you ever seen a movie that starts with a big scene? Maybe an explosion. Maybe a chase. Maybe a giant monster. The movie starts with something big. And you know it is going to be a big story. The Bible starts with a big beginning. It starts with creation. It starts with a garden. It starts with a promise. And every big story in the beginning points to something even bigger. It points to Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to look at the big beginning. We are going to see the big stories. We are going to find the big clues. And we are going to discover the biggest treasure of all. That treasure is Jesus. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need to be willing to explore with your kids. Get ready to go on a big adventure. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the big clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Big Beginning of Everything

The Big Clue (OT)
"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1

This is the biggest beginning of all. It is the very first verse in the Bible. It says, "In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." God made everything. He made the sky. He made the ground. He made the sun. He made the moon. He made the stars. He made it all. This is the big beginning of everything.

The Big Reveal (NT)

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God." - John 1:1

The Gospel of John starts with the same words. "In the beginning." But John tells us about the Word. The Word was with God. The Word was God. The Word is Jesus. Jesus was there in the big beginning. He was there when God created everything.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of something big God made. A mountain. An ocean. A galaxy. Write the name "Jesus" at the top. Talk about how Jesus was there in the big beginning.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the big beginning. Thank you for making everything. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you that He was there in the beginning. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big, beautiful world with a big bright sun and a little heart in the middle.

Day 02: The Big Beginning of Light

The Big Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light." - Genesis 1:3

The world was dark. It was empty. It was quiet. Then God spoke. He said, "Let there be light." And there was light. The light was bright. The light was good. It was the big beginning of light.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the light of the world. He is the one who shines in the darkness. He is the one who makes the dark places bright. The big beginning of light points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Turn off the lights in your room. Sit in the dark for a moment. Then turn on a big light. Talk about how Jesus is the big light that makes everything bright.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the light. Thank you for shining in the darkness. Thank you for making my heart bright. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big, bright candle shining in a dark room with a big smile.

Day 03: The Big Beginning of the Sky

The Big Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be a vault between the waters to separate water from water.'" - Genesis 1:6

God made the sky. He separated the water below from the water above. He made a big space. He made a home for the birds. He made a home for the clouds. It was the big beginning of the sky.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of God. He is the firstborn over all creation. He is the one who made the sky. He is the one who made the clouds. He is the one who made the birds. The big beginning of the sky points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Go outside. Look at the big sky. Look at the clouds. Look at the birds. Talk about how Jesus made all of it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the big sky. Thank you for the clouds. Thank you for the birds. Thank you for the beautiful world. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big blue sky with fluffy white clouds and a little bird.

Day 04: The Big Beginning of the Land

The Big Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let the water under the sky be gathered to one place, and let dry ground appear.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:9

God made the land. He gathered the water together. He made the dry ground appear. He made the big mountains. He made the big valleys. He made the big beaches. It was the big beginning of the land.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The earth is the LORD's, and everything in it, the world, and all who live in it; for he founded it on the seas and established it on the waters." - Psalm 24:1-2

Jesus is the Lord of the earth. He is the one who made the land. He is the one who made the mountains. He is the one who made the beaches. The big beginning of the land points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big mountain or a big beach. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus made the big land.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the big land. Thank you for the mountains. Thank you for the beaches. Thank you for the beautiful world. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big mountain with a green valley and a little tree.

Day 05: The Big Beginning of Plants

The Big Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let the land produce vegetation: seed-bearing plants and trees on the land that bear fruit with seed in it, according to their various kinds.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:11

God made the plants. He made the big trees. He made the little flowers. He made the grass. He made the fruit. He made the seeds. It was the big beginning of plants.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. We are the branches. We bear fruit. He is the source of life. He is the source of growth. The big beginning of plants points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Plant a big seed in a cup. Water it. Put it in the sun. Watch it grow over the next few weeks. Talk about how Jesus makes things grow.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the plants. Thank you for the big trees. Thank you for the little flowers. Thank you for making things grow. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big garden with tall trees, colorful flowers, and a big smile.

Day 06: The Big Beginning of the Sun and Moon

The Big Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be lights in the vault of the sky to separate the day from the night, and let them serve as signs to mark sacred times, and days and years.'" - Genesis 1:14

God made the big sun. He made the big moon. He made the big stars. He made them to shine. He made them to give light. He made them to mark the days and the nights. It was the big beginning of the sun and moon.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the greater light. He is the light that never goes out. The big beginning of the sun and moon points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Go outside at night. Look at the big moon. Look at the big stars. Talk about how Jesus made them. Talk about how He is the light that never goes out.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the big sun. Thank you for making the big moon. Thank you for making the big stars. Thank you for being the light that never goes out. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big sun in the day and a big moon and stars at night.

Day 07: The Big Beginning of Sea Creatures

The Big Clue (OT)
"So God created the great creatures of the sea and every living thing with which the water teems and that moves about in it, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:21

God made the big sea creatures. He made the big whales. He made the big fish. He made the little fish. He made the birds. He made them all. It was the big beginning of sea creatures.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"As Jesus was walking beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew. They were casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen. 'Come, follow me,' Jesus said, 'and I will send you out to fish for people.'" - Matthew 4:18-19

Jesus called fishermen. He called them to follow Him. He called them to fish for people. The big beginning of sea creatures points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big fish. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus called the fishermen to follow Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the big fish. Thank you for making the birds. Thank you for calling the fishermen. Thank you for calling me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big fish with a big smile and a little bird flying above.

Day 08: The Big Beginning of Animals

The Big Clue (OT)
"And God made the wild animals according to their kinds, the livestock according to their kinds, and all the creatures that move along the ground according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:25

God made the big animals. He made the big lions. He made the big elephants. He made the little lambs. He made the bugs. He made them all. It was the big beginning of animals.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" - John 1:29

Jesus is the Lamb. He is the Lamb of God. He takes away the sin of the world. The big beginning of animals points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus is the Lamb of God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the animals. Thank you for the big lions. Thank you for the little lambs. Thank you for being the Lamb of God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big fluffy white lamb with a big smile and a little heart.

Day 09: The Big Beginning of People

The Big Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let us make mankind in our image, in our likeness, so that they may rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky, over the livestock and all the wild animals, and over all the creatures that move along the ground.'" - Genesis 1:26

God made people. He made the very first people. He made Adam. He made Eve. He made them in His image. He made them to be like Him. It was the big beginning of people.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of God. He is the true image. He is the perfect likeness. The big beginning of people points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Look in the mirror. Talk about how you are made in the image of God. Talk about how Jesus is the perfect image of God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for making me. Thank you for making me in your image. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you that He is the perfect image of God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A happy family holding hands with a big heart in the middle.

Day 10: The Big Beginning of Rest

The Big Clue (OT)
"By the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; so on the seventh day he rested from all his work. Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it he rested from all the work of creating that he had done." - Genesis 2:2-3

God made everything in six days. Then He rested. He stopped. He took a big break. He enjoyed what He made. He blessed the seventh day. It was the big beginning of rest.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the rest. He is the one who gives rest. He is the one who gives peace. The big beginning of rest points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Take a big nap. Read a big book. Go for a big walk. Do something restful. Talk about how Jesus gives us rest.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for rest. Thank you for giving me rest. Thank you for giving me peace. Help me to rest in you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person sleeping peacefully with a big smile and a little "Zzz."

Day 11: The Big Beginning of the Garden

The Big Clue (OT)
"Now the LORD God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed. The LORD God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground—trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." - Genesis 2:8-9

God planted a big garden. He planted it in Eden. He put the man there. He made big trees grow. Trees that were pretty. Trees that had food. In the middle of the garden was the tree of life. It was the big beginning of the garden.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Then Jesus said to them, 'Very truly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you. Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day.'" - John 6:53-54

Jesus is the tree of life. He is the one who gives eternal life. The big beginning of the garden points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big garden. Draw a big tree in the middle. Write the name "Jesus" on the tree. Talk about how Jesus is the tree of life.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the tree of life. Thank you for giving me life. Thank you for giving me eternal life. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big beautiful garden with a big tree in the middle and a big smile.

Day 12: The Big Beginning of the River

The Big Clue (OT)
"A river watering the garden flowed from Eden; from there it was separated into four headwaters." - Genesis 2:10

A big river flowed from Eden. It watered the garden. It brought life. It brought refreshment. It brought blessing. It was the big beginning of the river.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Whoever believes in me, as Scripture has said, rivers of living water will flow from within them. By this he meant the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were later to receive." - John 7:38-39

Jesus is the river of living water. He is the source of life. He is the source of refreshment. The big beginning of the river points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Drink a big glass of water. As you drink it, talk about how Jesus is the living water. Talk about how He refreshes our souls.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for refreshing my soul. Thank you for filling me up. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big beautiful river flowing through a garden with a big smile.

Day 13: The Big Beginning of the Command

The Big Clue (OT)
"And the LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.'" - Genesis 2:16-17

God gave a big command. He gave a big rule. He said, "You can eat from any tree. But you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." It was a big test. It was a big boundary. It was the big beginning of the command.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He broke the big rule. But Jesus obeyed. He kept the big rule. He never sinned. The big beginning of the command points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Play a big game of "Simon Says." Talk about how Jesus always obeyed. Talk about how He kept the rules for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying. Thank you for keeping the rules. Thank you for taking my disobedience. Help me to obey you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a checkmark inside it.

Day 14: The Big Beginning of the Helper

The Big Clue (OT)
"The LORD God said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for him.'" - Genesis 2:18

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." He made a big helper. He made a big companion. He made Eve. It was a big gift. It was the big beginning of the helper.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another advocate to help you and be with you forever—the Spirit of truth." - John 14:16-17

Jesus promised a big helper. He promised the Holy Spirit. He promised a big companion. The big beginning of the helper points to the Holy Spirit.

Family Activity
Write down one big thing you need help with. Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to help you. Thank Him for being your helper.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the helper. Thank you for the Holy Spirit. Thank you for being with me. Thank you for helping me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Two big friends holding hands with a big heart between them.

Day 15: The Big Beginning of the Rib

The Big Clue (OT)
"But for Adam no suitable helper was found. So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and then closed up the place with flesh. Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man." - Genesis 2:20-22

God caused Adam to fall into a big sleep. He took a big rib. He made a big woman. He brought her to the man. It was a big story. It was the big beginning of the rib.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For we are members of his body. 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.' This is a profound mystery—but I am talking about Christ and the church." - Ephesians 5:30-32

Paul says the story of Adam and Eve is a big mystery. It is about Christ and the church. Jesus slept in death. He took a big wound in his side. He created the church. The big beginning of the rib points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think about your big church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the church. Thank you for making me part of your big family. Thank you for making me belong. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big church building with a big heart on the door.

Day 16: The Big Beginning of the Snake

The Big Clue (OT)
"Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God really say, "You must not eat from any tree in the garden"?'" - Genesis 3:1

The big snake was sneaky. He was tricky. He asked the woman a big question. He tried to trick her. He tried to make her doubt God. It was the big beginning of the snake.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil, or Satan, who leads the whole world astray." - Revelation 12:9

The big snake is the devil. He is Satan. He is the one who tries to trick us. But Jesus defeated him. Jesus crushed his big head. The big beginning of the snake points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big snake. Then draw a big shoe stepping on it. Write the words "Jesus wins!" Talk about how Jesus defeated the big snake.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for defeating the big snake. Thank you for winning the victory. Help me to resist temptation. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big shoe stepping on a big snake with a big glowing smile.

Day 17: The Big Beginning of the Sad Day

The Big Clue (OT)

"When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it." - Genesis 3:6

The woman saw the big fruit. She ate it. She gave it to her husband. He ate it. They disobeyed. They sinned. It was a big sad day. It was the big beginning of the sad day.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus obeyed. He brought righteousness into the world. The big sad day points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Talk about a big mistake you made. Talk about how Jesus took your big mistake. Thank Him for His grace.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for taking my big mistakes. Thank you for giving me your goodness. Help me to obey you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big sad face turning into a big happy face with a big heart.

Day 18: The Big Beginning of the Fig Leaves

The Big Clue (OT)
"Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves." - Genesis 3:7

Adam and Eve ate the fruit. They felt big shame. They tried to cover themselves with big fig leaves. They tried to fix their own big problem. But it did not work. It was the big beginning of the fig leaves.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the big covering. He is the big clothing. He covers our big shame. He covers our big sin. The big beginning of the fig leaves points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Put on a big favorite piece of clothing. Talk about how Jesus covers us. Talk about how He takes away our big shame.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for covering me. Thank you for taking away my big shame. Thank you for clothing me with your love. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big warm winter coat with a big heart on it.

Day 19: The Big Beginning of the Question

The Big Clue (OT)
"But the LORD God called to the man, 'Where are you?'" - Genesis 3:9

God called to Adam. He said, "Where are you?" It was a big question. It was a big search. God was looking for Adam. He was seeking him. It was the big beginning of the question.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the big seeker. He is the one who comes looking. He is the one who calls. He is the one who saves. The big beginning of the question points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Play a big game of hide and seek. Let your child hide. Then find them and say, "I always find you!" Talk about how Jesus always finds us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for seeking me. Thank you for finding me. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big eye looking for something with a big heart next to it.

Day 20: The Big Beginning of the Promise

The Big Clue (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15

God spoke to the big snake. He said, "A descendant of the woman will come. He will crush your big head." It was the very first big promise. It was the big beginning of the promise.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the big descendant. He was born of a woman. He crushed the big snake's head. The big beginning of the promise points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Write down one big promise from God that you are holding onto. Say it out loud. Thank God for keeping His big promises.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the big promise. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the big snake's head. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a big cross inside it and a big smile.

Day 21: The Big Beginning of the Sacrifice

The Big Clue (OT)
"The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them." - Genesis 3:21

God made big clothes for Adam and Eve. He made them out of big animal skin. A big animal had to die. Big blood had to be shed. It was the very first big sacrifice. It was the big beginning of the sacrifice.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the big sacrifice. He is the big covering. His big blood was shed. His big life was given. The big beginning of the sacrifice points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Put on a big favorite piece of clothing. As you put it on, thank Jesus for covering you with His big love. Thank Him for His big sacrifice.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the big sacrifice. Thank you for covering me. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big warm coat with a big heart and a big cross on it.

Day 22: The Big Beginning of the Exile

The Big Clue (OT)
"So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." - Genesis 3:23

God sent Adam out of the big garden. He had to leave. He had to go. It was a big sad day. It was the big beginning of the exile.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have gained access by faith into this grace in which we now stand." - Romans 5:1-2

Jesus brings us back. He restores our big access. He brings us into big grace. The big beginning of the exile points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a big time you felt far from God. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus brings me back." Thank Him for restoring your access to God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for bringing me back. Thank you for restoring my access. Thank you for bringing me into grace. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big door opening into a big beautiful garden with a big smile.

Day 23: The Big Beginning of the Guards

The Big Clue (OT)
"After he drove the man out, he placed on the east side of the Garden of Eden cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life." - Genesis 3:24

God placed big angels at the big garden. They were big guards. They had a big flaming sword. They guarded the way to the big tree of life. It was the big beginning of the guards.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit. At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:50-51

Jesus removed the big barrier. He tore the big curtain. He opened the big way. The big beginning of the guards points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big curtain. Then draw a big line through it, tearing it in two. Write the word "Jesus" on the big tear. Thank Him for opening the way to God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for opening the big way. Thank you for removing the big barrier. Thank you for letting me come to God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big torn curtain with a big heart and a big cross.

Day 24: The Big Beginning of the Brothers

The Big Clue (OT)
"Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him." - Genesis 4:8

Cain was big jealous. He was big angry. He killed his brother Abel. It was the very first big murder. It was a big sad day. It was the big beginning of the brothers.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him." - John 8:44

Cain belonged to the devil. He was a big murderer. But Jesus is different. He is the big innocent one. He is the one who was killed. The big beginning of the brothers points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of someone who has hurt you. Write their name down. Then pray for them. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for understanding my big pain. Thank you for being wounded for me. Help me to forgive those who have hurt me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a big bandage on it and a big smile.

Day 25: The Big Beginning of the Blood

The Big Clue (OT)
"The LORD said, 'What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.'" - Genesis 4:10

Abel's big blood cried out. It cried out for big justice. It cried out from the ground. It was the very first big blood. It was the big beginning of the blood.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"To Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." - Hebrews 12:24

Jesus' big blood speaks a better word. It speaks big forgiveness. It speaks big grace. It speaks big mercy. The big beginning of the blood points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a big sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus' blood speaks big forgiveness over me." Thank Him for His big grace.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for your big blood. Thank you for speaking big forgiveness over me. Thank you for grace. Thank you for mercy. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a big drop of blood and a big smile.

Day 26: The Big Beginning of the Boat

The Big Clue (OT)
"So make yourself an ark of cypress wood; make rooms in it and coat it with pitch inside and out." - Genesis 6:14

God told Noah to build a big boat. It was a very big boat. It was called an ark. It was a big rescue. It was a big safe place. It was the big beginning of the boat.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit." - 1 Peter 3:18

Jesus is the big ark. He is the big rescue. He is the big safe place. He suffered for sins. He brought us to God. The big beginning of the boat points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a big boat. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Thank Him for being your big ark. Thank Him for saving you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my big ark. Thank you for being my big rescue. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big boat with animals and a big rainbow and a big smile.

Day 27: The Big Beginning of the Rainbow

The Big Clue (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13

God set a big rainbow in the big clouds. It was a big sign. It was a big promise. It was a big reminder. It was the big beginning of the rainbow.

The Big Reveal (NT)
*"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is

……

Day 27: The Big Beginning of the Rainbow (Continued)

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the big book of life. He is the one who saves. The big rainbow is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a big sign. You might need a big promise. You might need a big reminder. Remember the big rainbow. Remember Jesus. He is the big sign. He is the big promise. He is the big reminder. He is the one who saves.

Family Activity
Draw a big rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His big promises to you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the big rainbow. Thank you for the big promise. Thank you for keeping your big promises. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big beautiful rainbow stretching across the sky with a big smile.

Day 28: The Big Beginning of the Tower

The Big Clue (OT)
"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4

The people wanted to build a big tower. They wanted to reach big heaven. They wanted to make a big name for themselves. They wanted to be big and famous. But God had a different plan. It was the big beginning of the tower.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus made a big name for himself. He did not build a big tower. He came down from big heaven. He made a big name that is above every name. The big tower points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Build a big tower out of blocks. See how high you can make it. Then knock it down. Talk about how Jesus is the one who makes a name that lasts forever.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making a big name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down to reach me. Help me to trust your big name. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big tall tower with a big smile and a little heart at the top.

Day 29: The Big Beginning of the Call

The Big Clue (OT)
"The LORD had said to Abram, 'Go from your country, your people and your father's household to the land I will show you.'" - Genesis 12:1

God called Abraham. He told him to leave his big home. He told him to leave his big family. He told him to go to a big new land. It was the start of a big adventure. It was the big beginning of the call.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Come, follow me," Jesus said, "and I will send you out to fish for people." - Matthew 4:19

Jesus calls us. He tells us to follow Him. He tells us to leave our old big life behind. He tells us to go where He leads. The big call points to Jesus.

Family Activity

Think of a big step of faith you need to take. Write it down. Ask God to help you take it. Ask Him to help you follow the big call.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the big call. Thank you for calling me. Help me to answer the big call. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person walking on a big path with a big smile and a big bright light ahead.

Day 30: The Big Beginning of the Promise

The Big Clue (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:2-3

God made a big promise to Abraham. He said, "I will make you into a big nation. I will bless you. I will make your name big. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." It was a big promise. It was a big hope. It was the big beginning of the promise.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the big promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole big world. The big promise to Abraham points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think about your big family. Write down one way you can be a big blessing to them this week. Ask God to help you do it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the big promise. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for making me part of your big family. Help me to be a big blessing to others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big family with a big heart in the middle and a big shining star above.

END MATTER

The "Big Story" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Big Beginning adventure. You followed 30 big clues and discovered the biggest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Big Story Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was your favorite big story from this book?
Card 2: What was the biggest clue you found?
Card 3: Why do you think God gave us so many big stories about Jesus?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus was there in the big beginning?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' big love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one big thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days exploring the big beginning with your children. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: Genesis for Kids

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. Genesis for Kids takes you on a journey through 30 days of creation, animals, and the coming King. It is full of activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, beautiful world. The world is glowing. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. The title THE BIG BEGINNING is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word BIG is in bright red with a globe replacing the letter I. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.